

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

SENATE CONCURRENT
RESOLUTION 17

By: Boren and McIntosh of the
Senate

and

Hill and Stewart of the
House

AS INTRODUCED

A Concurrent Resolution recognizing the long
friendship between Oklahoma and Ireland;
commemorating economic relations between Ireland and
Oklahoma; welcoming esteemed guests from Ireland;
recognizing ties between Ireland and the United
States and the Irish ancestry of many Oklahomans;
commemorating the celebration of St. Patrick's Day
throughout the state; and directing distribution.

WHEREAS, Oklahoma and Ireland have enjoyed a long friendship
that predates Oklahoma's statehood and Ireland's independence; and

WHEREAS, in 1847, during the Irish famine, the Choctaw Nation
raised \$170.00 for famine relief, over \$5,000.00 in today's money,
which was a fortune at the time, even though they had recently been
forcibly moved to Oklahoma on the Trail of Tears; and

WHEREAS, in 2017, Ireland commemorated the gift of the Choctaw
Nation with the dedication of the Kindred Spirits sculpture,
featuring a circle of eagle feathers, in County Cork; and

1 WHEREAS, the Choctaw Nation unveiled on August 30, 2024, as a
2 tribute to their connection with Ireland, the Eternal Heart
3 sculpture, depicting a Celtic Trinity knot intertwined with a heart,
4 facing the east toward Ireland; and

5 WHEREAS, in 2024, Oklahoma established the Oklahoma Ireland
6 Trade Commission for Oklahoma businesses and industries to benefit
7 from Ireland's position within the European trade market; and

8 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma State Legislature is honored to welcome
9 Senator Aubrey McCarthy, of the Irish Senate, and Mr. Phil Thompson,
10 Chief Executive Officer of the humanitarian organization Tiglin, an
11 Irish organization dedicated to helping people overcome addiction,
12 homelessness, and social exclusion, which he co-founded alongside
13 Senator McCarthy in 2008. The two will meet with Oklahoma business
14 leaders regarding economic development opportunities between
15 Oklahoma and Ireland. Their visit also honors the 250th anniversary
16 of the adoption of the Declaration of Independence on July 4, 1776.
17 Three of the signatories were born in Ireland, and others were of
18 Irish descent; and

19 WHEREAS, many Oklahomans take pride in their Irish ancestry and
20 continue to preserve Irish culture through festivals and
21 celebrations, particularly in March, as Oklahomans honor the Patron
22 Saint of Ireland and celebrate Irish heritage, including Tulsa
23 IrishFest, ShamROCK the Gardens in Oklahoma City, and the Oklahoma
24

1 City St. Patrick's Parade in Stockyards City, with Margaret "Peg"
2 Malloy serving as this year's Grand Marshal.

3 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
4 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
5 CONCURRING THERIN:

6 THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature recognizes the state's long
7 history of friendship and relationships with Ireland.

8 THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature welcomes Senator Aubrey
9 McCarthy and Phil Thompson as they visit the Great State of
10 Oklahoma.

11 THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature commemorates March 17 as St.
12 Patrick's Day.

13 THAT a copy of this resolution be distributed to Senator Mark
14 Daly, Chair of the Senate of Ireland; and the Oklahoma American
15 Irish State Legislators Caucus.

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